Human-made Things in the Bible © United Bible Societies, 2025. Adapted from: The Works of Their Hands: Man-made Things in the Bible, by Ray Pritz © 2009 United Bible Societies. This work is licensed under Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0/).

Sheath, scabbard

2.3.1 Sheath, scabbard

References:

Hebrew נָדָן (nadan) 1CH 21:27

Hebrew תַּעַר (taʿar) 1SA 17:51, 2SA 20:8, JER 47:6, EZK 21:8, EZK 21:9, EZK 21:10, EZK 21:35

Greek θήκη (thēkē) JHN 18:11

Description:

Spear
Helmet
Shield
Sword in sheath

Body armor and weapons of a soldier (Image generated by ChatGPT using OpenAI technology)The sheath was a case or bag about the size and shape of a sword, used to cover and to carry the sword. It could be made of a variety of materials, usually leather, but also cloth, metal, or even wood. It was normally attached to a circular strap or belt that could be hung over the shoulder or tied around the waist. In later Old Testament times, when iron swords were too heavy for a belt alone, the sheath was attached to a combination of a belt and a shoulder strap.

Usage:

The sheath covered the blade of a sword in order to protect the blade and to protect the person carrying the sword and those around him from being cut accidentally.

Translation:

In some languages “sheath” may be rendered “leather bag for a sword,” “covering for a sword,” or “something in which a sword is carried.”